Joy Stays



Reflect & teach · Educators

Verse 1

We don’t start with all the answers,
We don’t rush to get it right,
We begin with something simple—
A spark, a laugh, a bit of light.
When the room feels safe and open,
When our shoulders drop their load,
Learning finds a place to land
Instead of feeling owed.

Chorus

When we laugh, we listen better,
When we smile, we stay.
Joy isn’t extra,
It’s how learning finds its way.
We don’t force it,
We don’t stray—
Joy walks in,
And learning stays.

Verse 2

It’s the song before the lesson,
It’s the wonder in the room,
It’s the moment someone realizes
“I can do this too.”
Not a break from what we’re teaching,
Not a prize we give away,
Joy is how the brain remembers
What it met along the way.

Chorus

When we laugh, we listen better,
When we smile, we stay.
Joy isn’t extra,
It’s how learning finds its way.
We don’t force it,
We don’t stray—
Joy walks in,
And learning stays.

Bridge (spoken or sung softly)

Joy doesn’t mean it’s easy.
Joy doesn’t mean it’s small.
It means we found a way to learn
Without losing ourselves at all.

Final Chorus (gentle lift)

When we laugh, we listen better,
When we smile, we stay.
Joy isn’t extra,
It’s how learning finds its way.
Side by side,
Day by day—
Joy comes first,
And learning stays.

Outro (spoken, optional)

Joy isn’t a reward.
It’s the door.